Why do you want to participate in this program and how do you think it will aid in your development? (max 300 words). *

I am looking to improve my understanding of essential traits which differentiate successful Leaders.

As I go through from formative learning years, I am keen to understand and appreciate critical leadership traits. In the ever-evolving world, where the only constant is change, I believe it is extremely important for every student to understand techniques of combining established leadership skills while addressing various climate and social issues

I believe adequate focus and research has not happened on applying “leadership skills” in social context. Leadership is often confused with someone with aggressive enterprising personality in business. I believe leadership skills are not limited to business and applies to all fields, including sports, media, job, etc. I also believe that learning skills is a science and can be harnessed with proper training.

The program will give me an opportunity to access and learn from best professors in the world. Listening to seasoned academicians who have real life experience of creating and being associated with powerful leaders from varied areas like business, politics, entertainment, etc will enrich my understanding of the topic. It will provide me global perspective on the topic and how economic and cultural differences in societies impact leadership styles. The program provides comprehensive exposure into all aspects of leadership and an opportunity to network with accomplished faculty and Harvard mentors.

I strongly feel about various social, climate and cultural issues facing our society but only have a vague understanding of to initiate change. I firmly believe that it is both the need and responsibility of today’s youth to work for leaving a better future for next generation. From societal perspective the need for leadership has moved from private enterprises to social leaders.

I had good experience participating in Columbia Entrepreneurship program last summer and was very impressed by efforts taken by The Big Red Group team to make the program a memorable experience for participants.

Please describe a situation where you failed, and what you learned from it? (max 300 words). *

There have many instates when things didn’t happen and per plan, but a particular situation has stayed with me. The experience is associated with my seeking to be elected as grade sports counsel lead when I was in Grade 7 (MYP 2).

I have learned that it is important to enjoy the process and not think excessively about the results. If I aspire to have a public life, I should be prepared to accept it in total along with all its shortcoming and backlashes. It is very important to have multi-dimensional perspective and have through planning and preparation.

I have learned that best way to deal with failure is to accept it as a normal and necessary part of the process. Instead of seeing failure as a personal flaw or a sign of incompetence, I have begun to see it as an opportunity to learn and grow. For me failure is not the opposite of success, but a feedback mechanism that tells you what works and what doesn't.

What are your aspirations and where do you envision yourself being in terms of your career and personal development five years from now? (max 300 words). *

I am 15 years old and in five years would have passed one of the most important phases of my life ie start of college years. I am keenly interested in finding tangible simple solutions for complex challenges which have emerged from uncontrolled human exploitation of natural resources. While there are issues facing the world today including climate change, poverty, inequality of wealth, education, disparity between real and reel world, etc.

I am looking forward to building my academic background in STEM field and develop a strong yet compassionate outlook. I am keen to lead change in the fields of climate change and education. Being a person of detail and perfectionist at heart I am looking forward to gaining high level of knowledge on major subjects.

I believe that a successful leader is one

(a) who is a dreamer and has vision about changes;
(b) has knowledge to convert ideas into products or services; and
(c) has social and emotional maturity to lead a cohesive team

I want to utilise my college years to learn from best teachers and build a strong foundation of both technical subject expertise and fundamental drivers. Along with academic excellence I am looking forward to building long lasting friends.

As part of my college journey, I am looking to

(a) gain clarity about the field I would want to purse my professional career;
(b) harness leadership skills;
(c) achieve hand-on experience during internship programs;
(d) work on research papers on diverse set of topics;
(e) finding time to travel extensively around the world and gain perspective about different cultures

My athletic sprits were tempered due to severe flat foot during my school days. I am undergoing targeted muscle building program and optimistic about getting back to competitive sports in times to come.